JETRO Business Brief 2026/10/09

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【GLOBAL】

◇WTO revises upward 2026 global merchandise trade outlook, buoyed by AI-related investments (Global)

●International Economics Division, Research Department

https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/5abffbde6a311287

【ASIA-OCEANIA】

◇South Korean government announces Green Transition (K-GX) strategy (South Korea)

●Seoul

https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/74851a5b11e948ec

◇RCEP ministerial meeting approves recommendation to establish working group on accession (ASEAN, Japan, South Korea, China, Australia, New Zealand)

●Jakarta

https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/44ed251d32b03d33

◇JETRO promotes Japanese cosmetics and beauty products at "Bangkok Japan Expo," develops sales channels through e-commerce (Thailand)

●Bangkok

https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/101e166e185f04c7

◇"KL20" held in Penang; new fund for semiconductor industry promotion also announced (Malaysia, Japan)

●Kuala Lumpur

https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/4baaf1fe551a70cf

◇Aeon Heights opens, first mid-scale store in northern Red River Delta (Vietnam, Japan)

●Hanoi

https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/20c134e925708440

◇Ben Luc-Long Thanh expressway fully opens (Vietnam)

●Ho Chi Minh City

https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/ccb1343e4aaeefa0

◇September Myanmar PMI deteriorates for first time in two months (Myanmar)
●Asia-Oceania Division, Research Department
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/a844038908f279ad

【NORTH AMERICA, CENTRAL AND SOUTH AMERICA】

◇U.S. Treasury Department issues first penalty to U.S. company under foreign investment control program (USA, China)
●New York
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/25266e36a562e4bb

◇"IMAPS 2026" held with focus on advanced packaging technology for AI semiconductors (USA, Japan)
●New York
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/f9e777e4bc79d5fa

◇U.S. USTR releases joint statement with 14 countries and regions on excess production, showing strengthened response stance (USA)
●New York
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/207629283b067118

◇Trump approval rating stands at 30% ahead of U.S. midterm elections, think tank survey shows (USA)
●Americas Division, Research Department
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/fc002d3b3c6bb501

◇China Zhongtong Bus to introduce 6 electric bus models in Brazil; local production also planned (Brazil, China)
●São Paulo
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/15977733d3a7be1a

◇Chile's September inflation at 4.1% year-on-year; continues to exceed central bank target (Chile)
●Santiago
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/9d124053fe2543f7

【EUROPE, RUSSIA, CENTRAL ASIA, AND THE CAUCASUS】

◇European Commission announces revised standardization rules to expedite and enhance flexibility in standard-setting (EU)
●Brussels
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/4b1dec3f4b6c8597

◇Spain dissolves parliament; general election scheduled for November 29, may impact industrial and energy policy (Spain)
●Madrid

https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/4e4dab21d5081034

◇JICA and JETRO present survey findings at seminar; neighboring countries' role in Ukraine logistics growing (Ukraine, Poland, Slovakia, Moldova)
●Europe Division, Research Department
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/c32fc69e78988d22

◇U.S.-Ukraine Investment Recovery Fund approves investments in critical minerals and energy sectors (Ukraine, USA)
●Europe Division, Research Department
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/ada3595688e01956

【MIDDLE EAST AND AFRICA】

◇Iran emphasizes expansion of economic cooperation with Eurasian Economic Union (EAEU) (Iran, Russia, Belarus, Armenia, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan)
●Dubai
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/982c3ccf2bab0c72

◇Attacks on Saudi Arabia's capital and southern international airport result in casualties (Saudi Arabia, Yemen, Middle East)
●Riyadh
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/2f31fdcb5cac3ce4

◇World Bank revises downward 2026 growth rate for GCC countries to negative 4.3% (Middle East, Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC), Middle East and North Africa (MENA), Afghanistan, Pakistan)
●Middle East and Africa Division, Research Department
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/976be82c4c01418e

◇World Bank report highlights regional disparities in AI utilization in Middle East and North Africa; identifies language data shortage as challenge (Middle East, Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC), Middle East and North Africa (MENA), Afghanistan, Pakistan)
●Middle East and Africa Division, Research Department
https://www.jetro.go.jp/biznews/c6c89c41f88aedd9

◇JETRO